

Or blinds? Or a shower curtain rod? Though big-ticket items like appliances are detailed in the inclusions and exclusions part of your contract, it doesn't exactly specify what will happen to the toilet paper.

The answer is maybe. Some sellers are generous, while others are absolutely stingy. We've seen sellers remove every lightbulb in the house—or, in one extreme instance, dig up every plant in the yard (only to be directed to replant everything, because that was a breach of contract).

A decent seller will make sure there is a roll of toilet paper on every spindle, a roll of paper towels in the kitchen, and at least one soap pump in the house. However, you should come prepared with a necessities box. Include all the good stuff—toilet paper, paper towels, soap, towels, a few glasses for drinking water, and all your caffeinated beverage necessities.

How do I pay my mortgage?

Silly as it seems, this is another one of the most commonly asked questions by first-time home buyers. You close on the house, move in, and a few weeks later, you might be thinking to yourself, “Did I miss something? I don't remember how to make my payment.”

Truth is, it's likely that no one directly told you *how* to do this, so you're not crazy. Before your first payment (the date of which will be specified in your loan documents), your lender should reach out to you with instructions. Most loan payments these days are made online.

If, for whatever reason, your lender doesn't reach out to you with payment instructions within the first month, feel free to reach out to them and ask about it. Just make sure you pay before the due date—being late with your first payment isn't exactly starting off on the right foot.

What happens when my lender sells off my mortgage to someone else?

Is anything going to change? Do I still contact my lender?

When your lender sells your mortgage to another servicer, the new company takes over. You don't need to contact the old lender any longer, and the new one will reach out to you in advance of your payment due date to let you know where to send the new payment.

Sometimes your lender will sell your loan but retain “servicing rights”—which means you still send payments to your initial lender, and